

Samsung SCX-4500

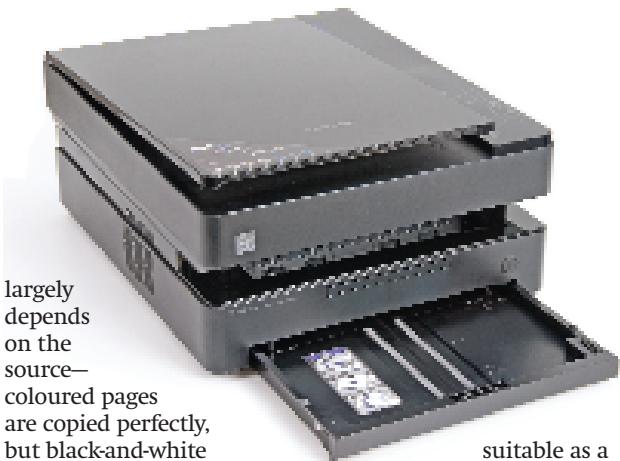
The Black beauty

Samsung's SCX-4500 is a multi-function device (MFD) that doesn't look like one. The paper cassette has a miniscule 100-sheet capacity; this eliminates the of SCX-4500 as a shared office resource. The detachable output tray can hardly hold any pages. There are very few buttons on the top, and all of them are touch operated. The LED display offers limited information, and general errors such as paper empty, paper jams are indicated via red glowing icons.

Installing the toner cartridge is simple—a catch below the scanner deck opens the cartridge bay and the slim cartridge fits in with hardly any effort—good for non-technical consumers. Samsung's ScanThru application takes care of setting the printer on the PC side. It also has additional features for

built-in OCR, colour correction, etc. Performance-wise, the SCX-4500 delivered 14 pages in a minute. Our taxing combi-document was printed in 16 seconds—not the fastest, but not slow at all. Print quality is typical Samsung—dark, sharp and crisp. Text is immaculately reproduced, ditto with reversed text. The printer unit reproduced all hues in the grey scale spectrum—quite good from a laser printer. The copier unit also performs admirably—the speed is fast, but quality isn't among the best we've seen. The quality of the copy

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★●
Performance	★★★★●
Build quality	★★★★●
Value for Money	★★★★●
Overall	★★★★●



largely depends on the source—coloured pages are copied perfectly, but black-and-white pages aren't reproduced that well—especially newspaper clippings etc. The scanner unit does a decent job at acceptable speeds. Edge-to-edge sharpness is excellent, and details are well-preserved.

At Rs 10,999, the Samsung SCX-4500 is sweetly priced. This stylish printer strikes the right chords—you get a beautiful-looking MFD that delivers where it matters. The SCX-4500 is more

suitable as a personal MFD or for a very small workgroup.

Specifications

Mono laser, 600 dpi print, 16 ppm, flatbed scanner, 600 x 2400 dpi scan, copy without PC, USB 2.0 and Samsung SmartThru driver

Contact: Samsung India Pvt Ltd
Phone: 011-41511234
E-mail: anupam.k@samsung.com
Web site: www.samsung.com/in
Price: Rs 10,999

Canon PowerShot SX100 IS

Easy Snapper!

The Canon PowerShot SX100 IS is the first ultra-zoom camera boasting 10x optical zoom in its compact body. Touted as the perfect camera in the hands of any family member, we found it to be true—the SX100 IS is simple to use, and delivers superb photographs with minimum tweaking.

The SX100 is relatively bulky and can only be carried around in a pouch—too large for any pocket. Similar to other A-series cameras from Canon, the SX100 has a plastic body, however it is well put together and exudes a built-to-last feel. Instead of a five way rocker, the SX100 IS has a rotating click wheel for browsing the menu—quite intuitive to use.

The SX100 IS an 8 Megapixel camera with 10x optical zoom, face detection and image stabilisation. The camera has other features typical to the A series of cameras—scene modes,

manual focus, colour swapping, panorama mode and so on. The 10x optical zoom combined with an excellent image stabilisation works wonders taking distance shots. The flash on this camera is simply superb—in fact, the best flash we have seen on any point-and-shoot camera. The SX100 IS uses AA size batteries—on an alkaline pair, we got around 120 photographs; using Ni-MH, batteries we got 400 shots—terrific. The downside to the use of AA batteries is the flash recycle time—painfully long, and becomes noticeable when batteries are low.

Colour rendition is accurate and natural. The camera

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★●
Performance	★★★★●
Ease of Use	★★★★●
Value for Money	★★★★●
Overall	★★★★●

performs admirably even in low ISO settings—we got excellent photographs even at 80 ISO. Higher sensitivity ISO setting such as ISO 800 and 1600 are completely useless—grainy images.

Working with manual focus and macro was fun, and it delivered some really good shots. The best part about SX100 IS is the ease with which anyone can take good photographs. Video capture is excellent. A 20-second video requires 30 MB of space.

Priced at Rs 19,000, the PowerShot SX100 IS is certainly expensive in India. At less than \$300 (Rs 12,000) abroad, the camera is a steal for the features and performance it offers. If you have any friends coming from

abroad, ask them to get you this camera.

Specifications

8 MP, 10X optical zoom, Image stabilization, 2.5-inch display, Manual focus, Scene modes, Video capture, SD memory card (512 MB included)

Contact: Canon India Pvt Ltd
Phone: 1800-345-33-66
E-mail: info@canon.co.in
Web site: www.canon.co.in
Price: Rs 19,000



Canon PIXMA MP610

All-in-One With A Class

The MP610 is the latest in the PIXMA range of inkjet multifunction devices from Canon. Successor to the feature rich PIXMA MP600, the new device boasts of significant upgrades to the scanner unit.

Like previous MFDs from Canon, the MP610 has dual paper feeding mechanisms—a top-loading tray at the back and the bottom cassette. Both these trays can hold a maximum of 150 sheets. The paper-feed selector switch on the top can be used for selecting either tray.

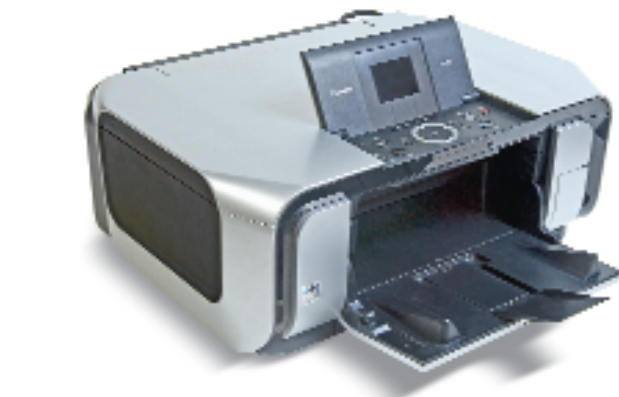
On the front, above the scanner unit, a fold up tilting panel has a 65mm TFT display and the button console. The TFT display is crisp and can easily rival any high-end cell phone screen. The control buttons are logical, and the command wheel is easy to use. Browsing the menu is intuitive, thanks to the

command wheel. The card reader is located just besides the output tray and it accepts almost all types of memory cards except for xD card; bad luck if you own Fuji or Olympus cameras.

The MP610 takes five cartridges and they clip on to the head assembly. These cartridges are illuminated Red when clipped properly into place. It features USB 2.0 and the port is located at the back of the machine.

The MP610 raced though the speed test and delivered the first print within 10 seconds. For the combi-document, it took around 34 seconds on normal printing quality and 50 seconds when

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★●
Performance	★★★★●
Ease of Use	★★★★●
Value for Money	★★★★●
Overall	★★★★●



taxed with best quality. Our photograph was printed in 70 seconds—relatively fast. On the quality front, the MP610 is very similar to other PIXMA printers—sharp text and negligible feathering. Photographs were stunningly reproduced—colour rendition was spot on.

The scanner is fast—preview times really amazed us, and scanning is equally fast too. The quality at 300 dpi was good, though details have an over-sharpened feel to them. Copying is fast thanks to the brilliant printer and scanner unit.

At Rs 17,995, the MP610 is reasonably priced for the features and performance on offer.

Specifications

Thermal Inkjet, 300 paper capacity, 2400 x 9600 dpi print, 14 PPM, five separate ink tanks, 4800 x 9600 dpi scan, copy without PC, SD/MMC/MS, CF support and auto-duplexer.

Contact: Canon India Pvt Ltd
Phone: 1800-345-33-66
E-mail: info@canon.co.in
Web site: www.canon.co.in
Price: Rs 17,995

Western Digital RE2-GP WD1000FYPS

Going Green Is Costly!

Everything seems to be about saving the environment these days, and Western Digital's latest drive with the GP badge is all about green computing. GP stands for Green Power, and WD claims these drive are more energy-efficient. The one we have for review is a 1 Terabyte monster. The drive has been developed to give as much performance as possible while keeping power down, by making optimum use of the cache and spin speeds of the drive. WD claims that the power consumption for the drive is 3-4 Watts less than the others.

Considering this is a RAID Edition drive, the performance isn't near the best by any standards. Even the desktop Caviar SE16 drives beat it in many places. The only place

where the RE2-GP actually catches up to the Caviar SE16 is in the SiSoft tests with data rates sequential and random file transfers differentiated by just 1 to 2MBps. HD-Tach also recorded similar data transfer rates. In real-world tests where files were copied to and from the drive, the RE2-GP fell behind other drives.

The temperatures tell the entire story, though. Just by feeling the drives we were using, it was clear the RE2 GP drive was considerably cooler. At around 40 degrees C, the WD RE2 GP ran some 7

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★●
Performance	★★★★●
Value for Money	★★★★●
Overall	★★★★●



degrees C cooler than the others after some intensive benchmarks—which is a lot. It is also very quiet, and the sound of the drive itself is drowned out by any fast fans that may be running—such as the graphics card fan.

The RE2 series isn't aimed at the desktop market. The price for the drive is Rs 17,000, which is a whole lot more than a standard 1 TB drive. The performance is above average, but if low temperatures, reliability and low noise emissions are

necessary, it's something you would want to buy—but it's still is too costly to consider for home use.

Specifications

Capacity: 1 TB, 16 MB Buffer, SATA-II Interface, Perpendicular recording

Contact: Western Digital
Phone: 9321029204
E-mail: amarjeet.singh@wdc.com
Web site: www.wdc.com
Price: Rs 17,000